

Paper 1: Physical geography

Externally assessed

1.1 Description

This paper brings together physical geography and people-environment processes and interactions. The paper is divided into two sections.

Section A – students choose **two** out of three topics from: river environments, coastal environments, hazardous environments.

- Topic 1: River environments – features of the global hydrological cycle (including drainage basins), the physical processes that give rise to distinct river landforms and detailed case studies of river management in a developed **and** a developing **or** emerging country.
- Topic 2: Coastal environments – the processes that give rise to characteristic coastal landforms, threats facing coastal ecosystems and detailed case studies of coastal management in a developed **and** a developing **or** emerging country.
- Topic 3: Hazardous environments – the characteristics and distribution of different types of natural hazard, the measurement and impacts of hazards and detailed case studies of the management of an earthquake in a developed **and** a developing **or** emerging country.

Section B – students are required to undertake a geographical investigation involving fieldwork and research, in **one** natural environment. In this paper, students choose **one** out of three fieldwork-related questions from: river environments, coastal environments, hazardous environments.

1.2 Assessment information

Examination length: 1 hour and 10 minutes.

Examination paper is in two sections.

Section A (50 marks).

Candidates choose **two** out of three questions on: river environments, coastal environments, hazardous environments.

Section B (20 marks).

Candidates choose **one** out of three fieldwork-related questions on: river environments, coastal environments, hazardous environments.

Total for paper: 70 marks.
